



2026 MLB Scout & Coaching Development Program – Scout Development Program Questionnaire

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Instructions: Thank you for your interest in participating in the MLB Scout & Coaching Development Program. Please complete this questionnaire as thoroughly as possible, as this exercise is to gain insight into your experiences and thought process. For the purposes of this exercise, please assume this questionnaire will be shared with all 30 MLB teams upon submission. Be sure to save as a PDF and include your name in the file name while saving (MLBSD_Last Name_First Name, example, “MLBSD_Brown_Jeffrey”). Please be sure to email the PDF document to mlbscoutcoachdev@mlb.com. Any additional questions can be directed at the email listed.

- 1. How does attending the 2026 MLB Scout & Coaching Development Program align with your career goals within baseball? What motivates you to consider such an opportunity? What aspects of scouting are you most excited to learn and explore? If interested in working specifically in a front office role, explain your area(s) of interest and how this opportunity will assist your growth as an executive.**

Attending the 2026 MLB Scout and Coaching Development program would enable me to turn my passion for baseball into a professional path by deepening my understanding of the game through scouting, evaluation, and player development. For my first two years out of college, I attempted to break into the business sector. While I secured a position, I realized I did not want to continue my professional career away from baseball, having played through college. My strong desire to combine my personal love and passion for baseball with my determination to advance my professional career motivates me to become a scout. I have always found myself analyzing offseason decisions, player swings, pitching mechanics, pitch sequencing, and more while watching games. That expanded to analyzing sabermetrics and advanced stats as I got older and furthered my own playing career. Scouting would allow me to turn the way I already study the game into a professional career built on evaluation, preparation, and player development. I am most interested in assessing prospect traits (fielding, power, contact, etc.) on a 20-80 scale so I can properly rate and rank them for more accurate recommendations.

- 2. If given the opportunity, what challenges do you think you would face as a scout, as you understand the position? What attributes, qualities, and characteristics do you believe define a successful scout?**

The biggest challenge I would face as a scout would be overcoming my inexperience in what baseball looks like behind the scenes. My previous employment was not in baseball, and I have not had the opportunity to work with an affiliate. However, what I lack for in professional baseball experience I make up for in a desire to learn; I follow MLB closely, listen to multiple podcasts (Just Baseball - stat based analysis of MLB team and player performance, The Call Up- stat based analysis of MiLB prospects, Effectively Wild - Fangraphs official podcast) to understand the inner workings of baseball, what stats are used to analyze hitters in today's age, and generally have the deepest understanding of the game I can have at every level.

A successful scout should have empathy for the players, be patient, be hardworking and competitive, love to travel and watch baseball, and, most importantly, be honest.

A scout needs empathy for players because of the difficulty and stress of being an MiLB prospect. The mental game is a major part of a player's success, and as scouts, our job can seem judgmental. Having empathy for the difficulty of baseball will allow scouts to see players in the most accurate light possible. Similarly, a scout needs to be patient. Players will have good and bad days, weeks, months, and even seasons, but it's important to be patient with their performances and look at the whole picture to assess and project them.

Scouts also need to be hard-working and competitive to gather the most accurate data and make the best recommendations. Success at the MLB level starts with acquiring quality players across every system, and it is a competition between teams' scouting departments to gather the most accurate information to get these players into their systems to develop. This means scouts need to work hard to uncover every piece of data and have the competitive edge to outscout the other organization's scouts.

Scouts should also be able to travel and watch baseball for extended hours. Being a thorough scout means covering the entire assigned territory and seeing as many players as possible, casting a wide net. This means frequent traveling and long hours in the ballpark are part of the job.

Lastly, a scout needs to be honest and patient. Scouts need to objectively look at player mechanics, decision-making, and makeup to make accurate projections. Biases toward prospects or player makeup cannot exist as a scout goes through their process. Demonstrating honesty and patience will help me build trust with players and colleagues, ensuring my evaluations are fair and reliable, which is essential for long-term success in scouting.

- 3. What should a scout look for when scouting a position player? In your opinion, what are the elements of a good swing?**

When looking at a position player, I first look at his "player card." I first look for defensive ability, handedness, and position before considering their athleticism, offensive tools, and how those traits project over time.

Looking at defensive ability first typically provides a good sense of the player's floor and offers insight into whether the player has the versatility to play multiple

positions for an organization. At shortstop, defensive ability is key, so the position typically looks for above-average athletes. This includes quick feet and the ability to move laterally quickly, good closing speed on slow ground balls, and good arm strength. Another important key to consider is the player's internal timing; is he rushing the ball to first, or does he understand his arm strength and the runner's speed to make the most accurate throw? This often can allude to a player's baseball IQ on defense and comfort level at the position. At 2B, I look for similar traits in quick feet, lateral quickness, and closing speed, with less emphasis on arm strength. At 3B, an offensive-minded position, I look at arm strength and reaction time. Is the player able to make throws from behind the bag, as well as deep throws from the glove side? Does he protect the 3rd base side from bunts? Typically, reactions and arm strength are key over range for potential 3B. For 1B, I look for good footwork around the bag. This includes not stretching early to see the ball's flight path and stretching accordingly, as well as positioning themselves well on picks in the first. Typically, good feet around the base lead to successful first basemen that save infielders' throws, handle pickoffs well, and enhance their stretch radius by using the edges of the bags.

When evaluating the outfield, I focus on specific traits for each position. In CF, similar to SS, I look for above-average athletes. A good CF needs to have good reads on the ball, efficient routes to baseballs, and good closing speed. I prefer CFs to run to the spot and get under the flyball to show their range, rather than coasting to it. CFs should also be most aggressive on the field, calling off other fielders for anything they can get. In RF, I look for good arm strength to protect against the 1st-to-3rd on single. In LF, typically an offensive-minded outfield position, I look for some combo of range or arm strength with a focus on offensive skills.

When analyzing offense, I will first look at the batter's swing and approach to gauge their game plan. A good swing should show balance, timing, efficient use of the lower half, quiet hands at the decision point, a direct bat path, and consistent barrel control.

In a swing, I first look at the back leg. The batter should not drift forward out of their back leg, as the back leg is where a hitter derives his power. I would like to see the back leg coil at the hip, and the batter keep his weight shifted back to start his coil/load. Next, I move up to the batter's hands. There are many different loads hitters take, and overall, I am not particular about how any of them look. However, at the moment the batter makes their swing decision, I try to ensure their hands are quiet and not moving to eliminate inconsistencies at the start of the swing. At the moment of decision, the batter's hips fire first, from the coiled back hip. There should be clear hip-shoulder separation in the batter, meaning his hips are firing as the hands stay relatively still. As the hands begin to move, there shouldn't be any exaggerated movements, such as major dips, or the hands being cast outward or widely tucked in towards the batter's stomach. The direction of the knob of the bat should be directly at the baseball during the swing, before allowing the barrel to whip through the zone. In good hitters, the barrel of the bat, because of the "whip" from the hip-shoulder separation, stays in the zone longer, and allows the hitter to barrel up a larger percentage of pitches in the zone. I also look at the barrel to see if the hitter can reach multiple areas of the plate and strike zone. If there is any major leg lift in the batter's swing, I will also closely examine the timing of the batter on fastballs and offspeed pitches to see whether the batter can read spin and adjust the leg lift accordingly.

As the swing finishes, I will look at the ball off the bat. A swing that results in hard contact should have the ball hit in the air with good backspin to optimize results. Is the batter hitting the ball up the middle or to the backside with good backspin to add carry, or is the hitter creating topspin and funneling the ball in front of the outfielders? Ideally, balls hit in the air should have good backspin, indicating the batter saw the pitch well, had good timing, and got the barrel to the baseball.

The last portion of a player I examine is the speed and baserunning ability. Speed is often considered a player's defining trait, but speed and baserunning ability do not go hand in hand. On the base paths, I look at players steal jumps first. Some players have the new-age steal reads, where they try to time their jumps with the pitcher's leg lift by doing a sort of crow-hop towards second. If a player does this, they typically need to be better at reading other timing to avoid being picked off. If the player continues to get good jumps and reads off pitchers, in addition to having good speed, this is a sign that the base-stealing ability is translating as the player progresses. On the basepaths, I also examine a player's tendency to take the next base, go 1st-to-3rd, cut the base close to maximize efficiency, read infield/outfield mistakes, and, overall, base-running IQ.

4. What should a scout look for when scouting a pitcher?

Mechanically, I look at both starters and relievers similarly when analyzing, but there are some differences I look for that I will note later. In pitches, I look for clean, effortless, repeatable mechanics. This can look different for every pitcher, but overall, the cadence from leg lift to back-leg drive to arm action, and the finish, should not result in inconsistencies in the motion or results. Clean mechanics include: good hip-shoulder separation, meaning the pitcher's upper torso should be closed relative to their lower half to create tension and ultimately velocity; good arm path, meaning as the pitcher drives and plants his front leg, is the arm path long by his hip? Short to his ear? Does his arm create good layback in his shoulder before firing over his front leg? Having a strong finish means the pitcher, after planting his front foot, aggressively/moderately/passively locks his front leg to transfer his momentum into the ball. Think Jacob DeGrom's hip-shoulder separation, Aroldis Chapman's shoulder layback, and Justin Verlander's front leg lock. These traits yield the most repeatable and efficient mechanics for performance, long-term success, and injury prevention. For relievers, less repeatable mechanics and more variability can be tolerated since their in-game samples are often restricted to 1-2 innings. Relievers can also benefit more from *less* repeatable mechanics if their arm angle and release point are outliers, such as Taylor Rogers, or any submarine pitcher.

Another important factor for starters and relievers alike is having some moxie on the mound. I want to see pitchers show poise, competitiveness, conviction in their pitch mix, and the ability to execute under pressure. Every play in a baseball game begins with the pitcher, but individually, pitchers often throw only 1 inning every 5 days as a starter, or every couple of days as a reliever. This combination means that when you are on the mound, the player needs to know what kind of pitcher they are, how they are going to attack the hitter, and have confidence in their pitch movement and pitch calling to be successful. Some of the most distinctive personalities in baseball have been pitchers: Max Scherzer, Carlos Zambrano, Al Hrabrowsky, and more, all of whom created a demeanor on the mound that defined their success. Any pitcher I am scouting needs to have this same feel for who he is on the mound. That doesn't mean every pitcher needs to be

yelling after every strikeout, but the best pitchers stand on their pitch mix and movement, don't shy away, and let the emotions fly when needed. Whether a calm, cool, collected killer, or an explosive gasoline can on the rubber, I want to see a pitcher that wants the ball to strut his stuff.

STARTERS

In pitchers, I differentiate more so when it comes to repertoires for what I am looking for. A starter should have multiple pitches in their repertoire, ideally at least 3, to allow them to pitch deep into starts. Additionally, I look for a starter's pitches to have 3 distinct movement profiles (e.g., FB/CB/CH, 2S/SL/FRK, CUT/SNK/12-6, etc.). For each of these pitches, there should be a high strike %, and the fastball should also have a 60-70% first pitch strike percentage. Additionally, starters should prioritize maintaining a high K-BB% (or a high K% and low BB%). The offspeed pitches should be thrown for strikes to demonstrate control and feel, but overall they should show the ability to miss barrels and get swings-and-misses. The starter should have a preferred offspeed for righties, lefties, and 2-strike situations. I also examine a player's "pitchability"; can the pitcher throw breaking balls behind in the count? Can they attack hitters when they have the lead? Do they win the first 3 pitches of an at-bat (1-2 instead of 2-1)? Do they get better or worse with RISP? Can they hold runners? Do they have effective pick-off moves? Do they mix in a slide step? Overall, anything that a pitcher can mentally do to help them progress through tough situations in an at-bat or an inning.

RELIEVERS

An effective relief pitcher would have at least 2 effective pitches, with an emphasis on a plus offspeed pitch. This means having one pitch with a high swing strike%, chase %, k%, groundball %, or anything that effectively gets hitters out at strong rates. Having a 3rd pitch helps relievers tremendously to keep hitter timing off, but relievers seeking high K% can often dominate for 1-inning spurts with 2 pitches. Relievers need to focus on maintaining strong performance metrics in the situations they encounter most. This includes the need to strand runners, get a double play GB, strike a batter out with a runner on 3rd, and more. Therefore, when scouting relievers, I look for those with high K%-BB% and FPS% (similar to starters), but also consider relievers' groundball, flyball, and line drive rates. Relievers who get a large portion of their outs on ground balls can be very effective at getting out of jams with inning-ending double plays. Similarly, relievers with high K%-BB% rates and high FPS% can come out of the bullpen with runners on to induce weak swings and prevent runners from advancing.

- 5. How important is player performance when evaluating a prospect? Which statistical performance indicators (metrics, etc.) do you factor into your pitcher evaluations and position player evaluations and how much weight do they have? In your opinion, how should analytics and technology be used in the evaluation process?**

Player performance is a part of prospect evaluation, but it can never tell the entire story. Statistics show what has happened, while analytics help explain why it happened and whether the performance is likely to continue. Player statistics often do not account for the multitude of variables in today's game: weather, ballpark, playing through injury, competition level, age differences, and more can all have an underlying effect on player

performance. Stats, therefore, can only paint a picture of what has happened in past games and cannot be considered a linear projection of future performance. I would use player performance and statistics more as a benchmark to evaluate mechanical changes, rolling trends, or the effects of an injury. For example, a player is slashing .200/.325/.350 on June 1, but on June 2, reduces the size of his leg lift due to inconsistent foot placement and timing. From June 2-June 30, the player slashes .230/.355/.435. The stats support that the change to the leg lift allowed the player to gain more power from batter timing. However, a deeper dive into the advanced metrics would be needed to determine the cause of the power surge. Is his barrel rate up? Does his spray chart show he is leaning more toward pull power? Is his z-contact % up?

When evaluating pitchers, I will first look at K%-BB%, FIP, and P/PA to evaluate on-field performance. This shows me how effectively the pitcher controls the three true outcomes of baseball and commands the zone. When deep-diving into a pitcher, I will look at his pitch metrics and advanced metrics. For their pitches, I look at velocity, spin rate, horizontal and induced vertical break. I will also look to compare spin axis and gyro degree of pitches that the pitcher tunnels/sequences well (FB/CH, FB/SL, etc.). For advanced player performance metrics, I look at whiff%, chase%, and barrel% for specific pitch-by-pitch performance analysis. I look at first-pitch strike % (FPS%), hard-hit rate, avg EV against, and flyball/groundball/line drive % to analyze how well the pitcher performs in the zone and to get batted-ball data against the pitcher.

When evaluating hitters, I go through a similar process. I look at OPS, BB%, and K% to gauge a player's on-base ability, power production, and strikeout potential. The advanced metrics I look at include zone contact %, swinging strike %, chase rate %, avg exit velocity, and fly ball/ground ball/line drive %.

Stats and analytics working together is like owning a sports car. Statistics give you a look at the surface of the car, showing how a player's on-field performance appears, or, in this metaphor, how expensive and fast the car looks. Analytics gives you a look under the hood at the engine, showing what produces the car's power and what drives the player's performance. Analytics should be used to enhance and fine-tune players' mechanics and decision-making to produce the best on-field results. However, one can not exist without the other. A nice-looking car with a minivan engine will look attractive but lack performance. A bad-looking car with an elite engine will not garner the financial attention often wanted when owning these cars. Therefore, statistics should be used for quick overviews of players and to see how their skill sets translate to the field, while analytics should be used to assess the sustainability of player performance over the long term.

- 6. Describe your exposure to current baseball technology (Rapsodo, HitTrax, Blast Motion, Synergy, BATS, TrackMan, etc.) and exposure to coding languages (SQL, R, Python, etc.). If applicable, please describe an experience or a project you have used these tools (if available, provide links or attachments for any projects).**

I have had extensive experience with Rapsodo technology. I played Division III baseball at Oberlin College, where we had access to multiple Rapsodo machines. Our teams used the Rapsodo for pitcher bullpens, intersquads, and hitter batting practice. I often analyzed pitchers' Rapsodo numbers, reviewed data, and worked with my pitching coach to implement improvements. I am also familiar with the hitting data Rapsodo produced, but as a pitcher, I was less involved in that process.

I also have brief experience with Trackman. My former college teammate is currently a scouting intern for the New York Boulders in the Frontier League. I have been fortunate enough to shadow him over the past few months, and the Boulders use Trackman as part of their pitch-tracking/tagging program. I have seen this tagging technology in use, along with the information it provides (hit distance, IVB, HB, 3D strike zone, etc.)

The other technology I do not have direct experience with, but I am familiar with some of the data it can produce (bat speed, attack angle, swing plane, etc.).

I'm actively building my coding skills by learning SQL and Python to enhance my ability to analyze baseball data and support scouting evaluations. I am enrolled in a free online Harvard course for SQL and plan to complete two Python programs on Kaggle, aiming to finish all projects by early fall. This demonstrates my ongoing efforts to improve my technical proficiency.

7. Congratulations, you have been hired as an area scout covering a territory (typically multiple states). Describe how you will proceed with your first 30 days on the job. What are your priorities?

I would break my scouting process into 3 parts.

PREGAME

Before entering the territory, I will conduct background research to develop a focused game plan. I would start by reviewing the territory's history of draft picks, beginning with Power 4 programs, midmajors, highly rated JUCO and HS programs, and D2/D3/NAIA (in that order, with high emphasis on D1/HS/JUCO, depending on the territory). I will reach out to the coaches of these programs to begin a dialogue and gain more information about potential draft prospects on their rosters. After gathering info on the strongest recruiting areas, I would look for additional events where many of these prospects or recruits will be competing (such as a showcase). This will depend on the time of year- summer/fall will have more showcases and a consolidated collegiate league.

After gaining an idea of what schools and areas in the territory to target, I will compare the area rankings with additional prospect and high school recruiting rankings to compile prospect reports and rankings over the past couple of years. Additional considerations include players who were previously drafted but are attending college, as well as highly recruited transfers who are new to the area. After compiling a list of top prospects and targets to consider, I would watch videos of each target to gain a general understanding of their strengths and weaknesses. This will give me a good idea of what to look for in each player, especially if at-bats or appearances are limited.

IN-GAME

While scouting players at each game or showcase, I will have two goals: note strengths, weaknesses, and any surprising traits or characteristics of players on the prospect list, and discover new talent not reported in rankings or reports who demonstrate 2+ tools on the diamond. I will watch the preselected prospects to confirm or deny any strong points or shortcomings seen on the video, while also gaining live in-game metrics and observing the player's general mental makeup as he progresses through 9 innings of baseball. Important aspects I look for in the mental game are overall body language after outs, errors, or general mistakes. I also look at how teammates respond to the player in the dugout and how the team interacts with the player as a whole. This gives me a sense of a player's attitude towards the team, how he sees himself as a member of the team, and

how his teammates view him. I will use a combination of pitch and hit-tracking tools to gather player data, while also taking physical notes on observed visual cues and tendencies.

While looking at the highly ranked prospects, it's important to watch all 27 outs of the game to avoid missing any potential prospects. Any list of prospects I choose to target before the game is simply a tool to help me prepare, but the job of a scout is to evaluate on-field performance and talent. Players that display outlier characteristics, such as an advanced hit tool, extreme raw power, elite speed and range in center, a unique pitch profile, or arm angle, are all valuable to organizations. Outlier characteristics, when combined with MLB development programs, often result in hidden gems and very serviceable MLB players that were never considered top high school or college prospects.

It is important that, while I am scouting, I do not set quotas for myself. If I go in with a list of 10 players to watch, I cannot force myself to project 3 of them as serviceable MLB or MiLB talent. I need to be honest about any player I am looking at, whether a preselected prospect to watch or a newly discovered prospect. This honesty builds trust and confidence in my evaluations, which is essential for credibility as a scout.

POST GAME

At the end of each week over the 30 days, I will compile my prospect notes, metrics, and rankings to identify standout players. This will include players with the highest floor, highest ceiling, most projectable, best fastball, best offspeed, etc., to allow the organization the opportunity to decide what direction to go. I will base my reports and summaries on metrics and performance to provide accurate projections of what the player could be for the organization. It's important to update these reports every week, not just after 30 days, as player performance can fluctuate from game to game and week to week. This will also allow me to compile rolling data to better assess player performance over a season or league.

- 8. Draft Pref List Exercise. Please view the following player descriptions. Based on the descriptions and information provided, please rank the order you would draft the following draft-eligible players (ex. B, D, C, F, etc.) and once completed, please explain your logic and reasoning for your draft selections below.**
- A. Power Four college productive RHH SS with average tools, ability to stick at SS, gap to gap LD bat, high OBP, high baseball IQ, ML bloodlines.
 - B. Athletic HS shortstop with future plus tools, ability to stick at SS, LH bat potential including power potential with additional strength gains, above average speed translates on the bases, excelled at major amateur showcases against top competition.
 - C. Power Four college Friday night RH starter, innings eater in college, strong 6'4" athletic frame, plus FB and plus breaking ball with starter traits, above average command, productive career against good competition, national stage exposure with Team USA and Cape Cod League.
 - D. Current HBCU D1 corner OF (previously played two years of JUCO ball after a limited HS baseball career), above average athlete with plus raw power, swing and miss tendencies presently, 6.60 60-yard dash (led the conference in SB's), future above average defender (possible move to CF).

- E. JUCO two-way RHP/OF, mid-90's arm strength, CB flashes plus, starter traits, feel to pitch and commands the zone, fringe prospect as a position player, above average athlete.
- F. Mid-Major college SS with plus LH bat potential, high contact rate, high OBP with good strike zone discipline, doubles power right now, fringe glove, feet, and arm strength.
- G. Power Four college catcher with plus receiving ability, plus arm strength with a quick release, plus RH power impact potential, has some swing and miss, good leadership traits.
- H. Small college LH starter who faced below average competition, 6'0" medium build, average velocity, plus breaking ball with above average CH, starter traits, high K rate and spin rate, low BB rate, former Cape Cod League All-Star.
- I. Power Four college 3B, plus RH power potential with some holes, fringe defense, above average arm strength, average running speed.
- J. RH hitting athletic HS CF, long wiry frame (6'5"), two sport D1 Power 4 commit (baseball/basketball), bat shows barrel impact, quick twitch athlete, plus runner with long strides, ability to stay in CF with continued instruction, limited baseball showcase exposure due to basketball but just scratching the surface, despite basketball involvement, very committed to playing baseball long-term.
- K. Power Four college RHS, strong build, fresh power arm with limited use in previous years, flashing upper 90's arm strength, plus slider with hard break, scattered command presently, high K rate and spin rate, below average walk rate.

Response:

Based on the provided player descriptions and information, my draft order would be:

TIER 1

- 1. C - P4 RHS
- 2. B - HS SS

TIER 2

- 3. A - P4 SS
- 4. H - SC LHS
- 5. F - MM SS
- 6. G - P4 C
- 7. D - HBCU OF

TIER 3

- 8. E - JUCO OF/RHP
- 9. J - HS CF
- 10. K - P4 RHS
- 11. I - P4 3B

When creating a draft board, I prioritized players that provide the most controllable value to teams, meaning I would target starting pitchers and position players

that play up the middle (C, SS, CF), with added value for positional versatility (either through playing experience or athletic ability).

Player C would be at the top of my draft board because of his good build, proven track record, strong peripherals, and controllable positional value to an organization. At 6'4 with an athletic frame, Player C has room to fill out, add strength to go deep into ball games and maintain velocity, and remains projectable even as a college arm. By also attending a Power 4 school with additional experience in high-level teams like the Cape Cod League (CCBL) and Team USA, Player C's arsenal has been tested against top competition. Player C also displays 2-plus pitches (FB/CB) with above-average command. This will help Player C maintain a high K% and a low BB% throughout his career. As a college arm, Player C should develop through the minor leagues quickly and provide instant value to an MLB club. A starting pitcher entering an organization with a strong build, background, and arsenal, under team control for 6 or 7 years (depending on promotion), is no better a target in the draft.

Player B would be #2 on my draft board, but not too far behind Player C. Depending on an organization's player development system, I could rank Player B ahead of Player C, highlighting how organizational context can influence prospect evaluation and ranking decisions.

Player B shows potential across all 5 tools and, as a HS prospect, has ample time to grow and refine his skills. Player B can stick at shortstop with future-plus tools, meaning he can defend well and has the arm strength needed to play good defensive shortstop. As a LH, Player B also gains an instant platoon advantage. Player B is very projectable, as he has power potential and, at 18, time to add strength to grow his power even more. Lastly, the above-average speed on the basepaths will only be amplified in today's game of basestealing. Player B projects as a strong power-speed (40HR/40SB potential) SS with good defense, and at 18, could develop his hit tool further to be a true 5-tool player at an extremely valuable position.

Player A would be #3 on my draft board. Player A displays good tools and holds a high floor, but lacks the ceiling of Players C and B. With the ability to stick at short, Player A has good defensive skills and can provide value up the middle. Player A, showing good production at a P4 college with a high OBP and good gap-to-gap skills, displays an above-average hit tool. Combine this with high baseball IQ and ML bloodlines, and Player A's floor is a high-IQ, good-defensive shortstop with a high contact rate and on-base skills. Player A's ceiling would rise if he can look into his LD rate to possibly increase launch angle and carry, thereby boosting power stats.

Player H would be #4 on my draft board. As mentioned when discussing Player C, controllable starting pitching is extremely valuable, and Player H is another strong starting pitcher in this class despite the average build and velocity. Player H would be targeted for his strong peripherals and, despite below-average college competition, his strong showing in the CCBL. Player H would project as a command-first LHS that uses his offspeed pitches to throw off hitter timing. Player H's plus breaking ball and above-average CH, if thrown frequently enough, would cause his average fastball velocity to play up. Player H remains projectable due to his high K% and low BB%, which indicate his ability to limit base runners, and his high spin rates, which reflect his strong pitch profile. Player H should continue to pitch well across MiL and ML levels with his plus offspeed pitches, due to his ability to be in the zone and limit hard contact.

Player F would be #5 on my draft board. Player F shows good hit tools and projects as a bat-first SS, with a move to 2B more likely. Player F has the platoon advantage as an LH and also shows advanced hit tools, with his high contact rate. Player F's on-base ability will also allow him to maintain pressure on opposing offenses even during slumps. Player F may not be able to stick at SS due to his average defensive tools and is better projected at 2B to protect his fringe arm strength. Player F would provide an organization with a high-contact rate, high OBP LH infielder capable of moving around the middle of the diamond.

Player G is #6 on my draft board. Advanced metrics like WAR show the great importance of defense for catchers. Often, strong defensive catchers with league-average offense grade out very highly in year-end WAR rankings. Strong defensive catchers help pitchers progress through the game, steal strikes, and limit additional bases. Player G's defensive traits provide ML organizations with a steady presence behind the plate, a presence needed in every ballgame. Offensively, Player G has the potential to be an impactful bat, as evidenced by his plus power from the right side. Despite his swing-and-miss, Player G's development path could lean into his swing-and-miss to attack his pitches more. Cal Raleigh in 2025 and Dillon Dingler in 2026 each sacrificed some swing-and-miss to maximize their power potential and have been highly productive offensive catchers. There is concern about his swing-and-miss, and he would produce lower overall numbers than the other positional prospects; therefore, he was ranked slightly lower than the previous 5 players for this.

Player D is #7 on my draft board. I see Player D as someone gaining more baseball experience and continuing to learn who he is as a player. Going from 2 years of JUCO to D1 after a limited HS career shows Player D, with more of an emphasis on baseball, has performed well and progressed quickly through the college ranks. Player D has swing-and-miss concerns to pair with his raw power, and there I do worry that, as he continues to gain experience, more unseen concerns will pop up. The ceiling for Player D, however, is the opposite: as he continues to gain experience, his swing-and-miss tendencies improve, and he is a power bat with elite range in CF. Player D may also show the best speed of the draft class with a 6.60 60, and would provide elite range in CF if he makes the defensive transition, while also translating to the basepaths. Player D has a high ceiling, higher than Players F and G in my opinion, but there are too many concerns regarding swing and miss and experience to rank Player D higher.

Player E is #8 on my draft board. From the description, it is clear Player E should focus on pitching for the quickest path to the majors. Recent college two-way players like Carson Benge, Nolan McLean, and Payton Tolle have all chosen a development path and have already produced strong results. It is ok to admit that Shohei Ohtani is a once-in-a-generation talent. Player E, an above-average athlete with stronger pitching skills, would develop more quickly this way. Player E shows good traits: good fastball velocity with a plus second offering, and a strong pitchability and knowledge of how to attack the zone. However, with his focus split in college, there is concern that he has not faced enough competition (and, depending on the quality of the JUCO league, may not have) to rank higher than other pitchers on this list. I also wonder if there is a chance he moves to the bullpen long-term to prioritize his fastball and plus-but-inconsistent curveball, though that could be avoided if he adds a third pitch.

Player J is #9 on my list. Player J was one of the tougher players to rank for me. Player J has high-end athletic upside in center field, but the limited baseball exposure creates major risk in the hit tool, approach, and defensive instincts. On one hand, he is in the top percentile of athletic ability, and his ceiling is a 40/40 Gold Glove center fielder. Reading that he is a plus runner with long strides instantly made me think of Konnor Griffin, who similarly strides hard down the basepaths. Griffin has already shown how that type of speed can wreck a game, with 65/78 stolen bases in 2025 and a MiLB 98th-percentile BSR on Baseball Savant. If he can combine his speed and range in center with his high barrel impact, Player J would be able to make consistent hard contact before flying around the bases. Being a quick-twitch athlete also suggests he has quick hands and should handle velocity as he progresses. The biggest concern, however, is that we simply do not know enough about Player J. Limited baseball experience due to basketball means there are questions we won't have answers to, and Player J will continue to learn who he is as a player. He has a high barrel impact, but is that due to limited exposure to most fastballs? He has a long, wiry frame; can he control his long levers to produce a consistent swing and limit potential swing-and-miss? Does he have an aggressive approach and a high chase rate? He is extremely fast and has the potential for elite range, but does he take good routes to the ball and maximize efficiency? Teams could absolutely dream on Player J, but I would recommend maybe taking that swing on him in the later rounds after securing higher-floor prospects.

Player K is the #10 player on the board. Player K profiles more as a reliever due to his high walk rate and scattered command, but has a good fastball and a high-spin slider. Player K, if able to refine his command to league average, has a high-octane fastball to pair with his slider. This puts his ceiling as a dominant closer, with a similar repertoire/pitch usage to Edwin Diaz. However, the scattered command and below-average walk rates are cause for concern, especially if his high spin adds to his lower strike percentage. Being consistently behind and with runners on base will result in poor outings. Player K may have a higher floor than Player J, but does not possess the same ceiling.

Player I is my #11 player on my draft board. Player I does not display any plus tools outside his power potential, limiting his overall ceiling. There is no mention of his college production, but his offensive profile is that of a moderate power hitter with a high K rate. Player I also profile as an average defender and an average athlete. Player I's plus power potential gives him a carrying tool, but the defensive limitations and swing holes lower the overall profile.

9. **Successful organizations typically prioritize the relationship between scouting and player development. If given the opportunity to have oversight over both areas, how do you see these two areas coexisting and working together? What are your priorities? Please explain your drafting strategy, development process, staffing, and logic to develop a formidable player development system. Please keep your response at 500 words or less.**

Scouting departments should identify desired skill sets, traits, and risks to make projections, while player development departments build individualized plans that incorporate those skill sets and risk evaluations into on-field improvement.

I would consult with my PD department to assess recent strengths and weaknesses in prospect development. If our PD system has had a strong history of developing contact rate in hitters and refining command in pitchers, I would prioritize the scouting

assignment to look for players that have those opposite traits; hitters with good power but swing and miss and questionable contact rate and pitchers with good velocity, spin rate, and offspeed pitches, but maybe a scattered command that he could develop in our system. Our scouts then provide PD with players they can best assist in their areas of expertise. If a position or skill set is missing from our prospect rankings, I would recommend that the front office fill this gap through free agency or a trade.

For the draft, I would want all scouts to first look for standardized “base” characteristics in players. In pitchers: frame, spin rates, command, lower-half mechanics (hip-shoulder separation, front-leg lock, rhythm, leg lift), and arm action. In hitters, frame, approach (early in count and 2 strike), back leg coil, front leg lock, hands (quick, direct to ball, or casting), bat path (compact or long), and timing (especially if leg lift). This will allow our scouting department to compare prospects' traits across multiple leagues and locations accurately. From there, scouts can assess specific aspects of mechanics and advanced metrics: bat speed, wOBA, hard hit, FPS%, K%-BB%, GB/FB/LD%, FIP, pitch usage, spray charts, more specific splits, etc. This would combine our scouts' on-field evaluations with advanced performance evaluators to gather a complete prospect profile and identify any outlier characteristics.

Gathering the prospect data and creating draft profiles will allow the scouting department to make suggestions and projections. Before any final draft decisions are made, PD should be consulted to ensure a structured plan for each player upon entering the organization.

Once in MiLB, it will be important to surround prospects with coaches who have baseball experience, can communicate with players and the front office, and, most of all, prioritize development. I would prioritize coaches who communicate well, understand development technology, and connect with players. This would allow the coach to translate any metrics PD attempts to target (e.g., reducing K rate; the coach can more directly adjust in-game approach relative to the current pitcher's in-game repertoire than PD could) into more on-field, tangible mechanical changes. I would target coaches with playing experience: minor league baseball is a grind, with tough travel schedules and heightened stress to perform and advance through the system. Coaches with empathy and an understanding of MiLB's struggles will help players feel more comfortable on the field, in the dugout, and in the clubhouse.

10. There have been recent discussions regarding making potential changes to the MLB Draft and the possible inclusion of an international draft. In your opinion, what changes would you recommend (if any) and make to the current draft and international signing structure and describe your reasons?

My recommendation would focus on improving access to player development, protecting amateur players, and creating a more structured path into professional baseball. My priority for the MLB draft structure would be to get prospects in the player development system as quickly as possible. MLB organizations can better use technology and tracking programs that not all college programs have access to. Therefore, I would recommend that all college players be draft-eligible after completing their sophomore year, similar to the owners' CBA proposal. However, the proposal by MLB owners removed eligibility from high school players. I see this as the biggest negative in their proposal because it limits opportunities for talented young players to enter the system early, which could hinder their development and fairness in access. Of the 12 largest

contracts handed out in MLB history, 11 of the players did not go to college. The most exciting young players in the game today (Kevin McGonigle, Konnor Griffin, Bryce Eldridge, Bobby Witt and more) did not go to college. The best and most popular players in MLB did not go to college because their talent was elite enough to contend at the highest level almost immediately. Removing players with these talents would decrease the overall quality of the game and unfairly punish players by preventing them from entering free agency at a younger age and reducing their earning potential.

The biggest difference between College Baseball and MiLB lies in their focus. College baseball emphasizes winning, with playing time given to the most productive performers, often at the expense of development. MiLB, on the other hand, prioritizes providing players with opportunities to succeed and fail and fostering growth throughout the minor leagues.

Because College Baseball places greater emphasis on year-in, year-out results, we see shorter leashes for players and fewer pitch-count restrictions. In the 2023 Super Regionals, Quinn Matthews of Stanford threw a CG with 16 strikeouts, but it took him 156 pitches. It was an all-time performance in a winner-take-all Game 3, but it shows the focus of college baseball. Quinn Matthews was drafted 1 month after he threw and is currently in the Cardinals system, but his 156-pitch outing before the draft shows the Stanford coaching staff were playing for 1 game, not necessarily for the next years of Matthews' career. Did Matthew want to come out or regret it? Probably not. Is it bad for a player, team, or program to want to win and have that competitive edge? Absolutely not. But as an MLB organization, getting players in my player development system to monitor workload and control their progression plans would prevent overuse issues driven by a focus on winning.

College Baseball coaches, with 50-60 games per year, also have a shorter leash for playing time with their players. College coaching staff may bench or reduce the roles of players who struggle early in the year. This does not provide a positive environment for player development; prospects need to experience both success and failure in their seasons and have a sense of comfort or trust that the organization is behind them and will support them through any struggles. We see organizations build trust with players through periods of struggle, and that trust pays off in time. Jordan Walker, already at 20 home runs in 2026, was deemed a disappointing prospect years prior because of his lack of offensive production compared to his projection. If the Cardinals did not allow Walker to take his lumps and adjust year over year, their team would not be one of the surprises in 2026.

The proposal of an international draft is more plausible than the proposed changes to the Amateur Draft. The current international signing structure is broken: it prioritizes not the players but rather the people around them and the system in place. The current priority for players and coaches in the international signing pool is to get the most money from MLB signing pools at any cost. There are countless reports of players and their families being endangered in an effort to make MLB. This past year, 14-year-old Ismael Ureña Pérez died after being injected with what was claimed to be steroids to try and enhance his baseball performance. Fernando Tatis Jr. tried to sue his former agency, claiming “predatory financial services”. Protecting young international prospects from these dangers is vital. As of 2026, 83% of international signings fail to make the majors.

There is a clear failure and sense of distrust within the international prospect pool that does not prioritize development.

Instituting an international draft would make the signing system more structured and better protected for payments. It would also allow a more defined signing structure to promote player development. On average, MLB organizations sign and pay out from their bonus pools to 10-15 players per signing period. I would recommend the international rounds be 15, with the final 5 rounds (11-15) as optional picks. This will allow front offices to have similar freedom to reassign bonus pool money to higher-priority prospects. Because draft positions act as bonus pool money, I would allow for these draft picks/slot pool amounts to be trade-eligible. Players eligible for the international draft will be from 16-18 years old outside the US, Canada, and PR. The most bonus pool money will set the order of the draft, but I would also expand the bonus pool to allow for greater flexibility for teams.

Creating a draft will add competitive balance to the international signing period and give signed prospects a clearer path to MLB, similar to highly drafted domestic players. This will reduce the number of shady coaches and organizations that prey on these kids' desire to play baseball in the US. Adding draft slots will also allow all drafted prospects to receive signing compensation. Currently, we will see teams give nearly all of their signing pool to one player. Having 10-15 rounds will allow drafted players to receive compensation that decreases in proportion to their draft position.

The biggest issue with my two proposals for changes to the Amateur and International Draft is that they require investment from MLB organizations and owners. A recent CBA provision that limited draft-eligible players to college upperclassmen is a sign they are trying to outsource development to college baseball rather than MiLB. They also proposed reducing rounds from 20 to 12 and reducing the bonus pool from \$358.7M to \$200M, indicating they are not looking to expand investment in the amateur draft. The owners' CBA proposal did support an international draft. My proposal focuses on investment as a whole for development and on protecting advocacy.

I disagree with the provision to send more MLB draft prospects to college because college baseball generally does not prioritize player development. As the popularity of baseball has risen sharply over the past five years, so have teams' overall franchise values, with year-over-year growth of 13% before the start of the 2026 season. The draft systems, therefore, should reflect the sport's growing popularity and reinvest in the players.

- 11. Optional Question -- If you have applied to attend the Scout Development Program in the past, what steps have you taken to improve your candidacy for the program and make you stand out among this year's applicants? Please explain your reasons.**

This is my first time applying to the Scout Development Program.

- 12. Optional Question -- Break down both a position player and pitcher you have observed (in-person, video, etc.) at either high school, college, or professional level in the last three years? Which tools, skills, and intangibles (player makeup, etc.) have you observed which will allow them to be successful? Feel free to attach any scouting reports or summaries (if readily available). If reports or notes are not available now, they can be sent later to mlbscoutcoachdev@mlb.com.**

I attended 3 games in the AA series between the Somerset Patriots (NYY AA) and the Binghamton Rumble Ponies (NYM AA) on 6/10/26, 6/12/26, and 6/14/26. I

chose 5 players that stood out over the 3 games and wrote player reports. Reports were sent as an attachment in an email to mlbscoutcoachdev@mlb.com with this questionnaire (same email where this questionnaire was found).

Also included is a personal project. I developed a pitch tracking website to help me personally track individual game data for player analysis. I plan to use the website for in-game analysis to build my scouting portfolio. Long-term, I aim to upload the website to the US App Store for wider use by coaches and players. I hope to give players, coaches, and teams more access to advanced performance data, similar to what they see on Fangraphs (whiff %, spray charts, swinging strike %, etc.). The app is still being fine-tuned in my free time and still has some bugs and user interface issues. However, the app's main functions are working. I recommend going to settings and clicking the sample button to view sample data on the dashboard,

13. The final word...Any last thoughts which you wish to share about yourself with the selection committee?

From 2019-2024, I attended Oberlin College, where I continued playing baseball as a pitcher. For my final two seasons, I served as team captain, and my experience as both a player and a leader is something I value and appreciate every day. The value of the connections I've made with others in baseball and the adrenaline I feel playing the game I love are unmatched. Up until graduation, the strong academic environment at Oberlin motivated me to pursue a career in corporate finance, using my degree in economics, business, and politics to its fullest potential. I worked for 2 companies over the last 2 years, as a life insurance salesman with Northwestern Mutual and an auto claims adjuster for Allstate Insurance. Each time, I was miserable, not doing my best work, and it was clear I was a shell of myself without baseball. I had convinced myself that life goes on without baseball once I graduated, but the truth is baseball is something I can never get enough of. While my resume and background may differ from others, my passion for baseball is genuine. My path has made me more intentional about pursuing baseball, and my playing background, leadership experience, self-directed scouting, and willingness to learn will enable me to grow through this program. My passion for baseball has never faded, and I have been reinvigorated at the thought of returning to it as a potential career in scouting.